
Elias Thorne Archival Conservator & Preservation Specialist Email:
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Professional Summary Meticulous and highly focused Archival Conservator with 8 years of experience in the physical preservation, repair, and cataloging of rare manuscripts and historical artifacts. Proven ability to work independently in climate-controlled, solitary laboratory environments. Highly specialized in chemical deacidification, structural paper repair, and handling fragile materials with zero requirement for public interaction or staff management.

Core Competencies

- **Specialized Techniques:** Document cleaning, tape removal, localized humidification, tear repair, and custom protective housing construction.
- **Materials Science:** Deep understanding of paper chemistry, leather bindings, and historical adhesives.
- **Environment Control:** Monitoring and adjusting temperature, humidity, and lux (light) levels for long-term artifact storage.
- **Languages:** Reading proficiency in Classical Latin and Old English for cataloging purposes.
- **Work Style:** Exceptional sustained concentration, extreme attention to micro-details, and comfort with prolonged solitary work.

Professional Experience

Senior Conservator *State Historical Society Vaults* | Oct 2019 – Present

- Work independently in a restricted-access laboratory to restore 18th and 19th-century municipal records and maps.
- Perform chemical treatments, including aqueous washing and alkalization, on over 2,000 deteriorating documents to halt acidic decay.
- Create detailed, technical condition reports for every artifact prior to and following treatment, maintaining strict internal cataloging standards.
- Operate specialized laboratory equipment (fume hoods, suction tables) in complete compliance with safety protocols.

Preservation Technician (Night Shift) *University Special Collections* | Jun 2016 – Sep 2019

- Conducted overnight, solo assessments of incoming archival acquisitions, ensuring no biological contaminants (e.g., mold, insects) entered the main vault.

- Constructed over 5,000 custom, acid-free drop-spine boxes and phase boxes for the safe housing of rare books.
- Digitized fragile glass-plate negatives using high-resolution macro photography in a darkroom environment.
- **Education**
- **Master of Science in Art Conservation** *Specialization in Paper and Book Conservator*
- **Bachelor of Arts in History** *Minor in Chemistry*